FUTURE MAKERS

DUNDEE

04.11.2026 - 05.11.2026

Powered by

ada.scot

LLOYDS BANKING GROUP

Innovation Challenge



Why

Future Makers aims to:

- Inspire students to explore technology careers
- Build practical design, engineering and problem-solving skills
- Encourage creativity and collaboration across diverse backgrounds
- Connect students with industry professionals and real-world experience
- Develop solutions to real industry challenges

What is Future Makers?

- Imagine Future Makers as a fast-paced, creative challenge where students come together to turn big ideas into real solutions.
- It's part hackathon, part design challenge and part playground for experimenting with technology.
- Teams dive into a real industry challenge, combining creativity, problem-solving, design and engineering to bring an idea to life.
- Think of it as a high-energy adventure where there's no single right answer and bold ideas are encouraged!
- Whether you love coding, designing, problem-solving or simply have a great idea, Future Makers is a chance to experiment, learn new skills, meet industry professionals and create something that could make a real difference.

When & Where

- Abertay Cyber Quarter | Dundee
- Wednesday 4 November, 10am–4pm
- Thursday 5 November, 10am–4pm
- Closing Celebration: Thursday, 4–6pm

Event Schedule

Timings

The event runs from 10am to 4pm on Wednesday 4 November, when the building will close. It will reopen at 10am the following day, and the event will finish at around 6pm.

Attendees

There will be 72 participants in total, forming 12 teams of six.

They will be college and university students.

Schedule

Day 1 – Wednesday 4 November | 10am–4pm

10am – Future Makers begins. Your team will explore the challenge, decide who you're designing for, develop your ideas and start creating your prototype.

You'll have support from Lloyds Banking Group helpers throughout the challenge, who'll be there to challenge your thinking, offer another perspective and help you develop your idea.

Day 2 – Thursday 5 November | 10am–4pm

10am – You'll continue developing and refining your solution.

1pm – Your solution will be assessed against the judging criteria.

3pm – The top three teams will then be selected to deliver a 10-minute final pitch to the judging panel, covering the problem, audience, solution, technology, potential impact and what you learnt.

Teams are then invited to the Ada Scotland Festival Closing Celebration from 4–6pm, where the competition winners will be announced.

The Challenge – Future Makers

Your team will identify a real problem or barrier contributing to the gender gap, decide who you want to help and use technology to create a solution. What that solution looks like is completely up to you.

- ✓ Prototype a game
- ✓ Build an AI-powered solution
- ✓ Create an app or web experience

Innovation Challenge

"How could technology help close the gender gap in STEM?"



- ✓ Explore and visualise data
- ✓ Build a cybersecurity experience
- ✓ Or create something completely different

There's no prescribed technology, no single right answer and you don't need to arrive with your solution already figured out.

Event Timeline – 4 November

Need some help along the way? Coaches specialising in AI, games, software and data will be available throughout the day to support teams as they develop their solutions.

Explore › **Imagine** › **Create**

10am
Doors open; refreshments are served, and you'll meet your team.

10.30am
Welcome from Rose Ulldemolins and Matthew Barr

10.45am
Rose Ulldemolins gives the Future Makers briefing.

11am
Let the creativity begin!

12.30pm
Lunch and an opportunity to network with other teams

1.15pm
Innovation continues

4pm
Day one ends



Event Timeline – 5 November

Need some help along the way? Coaches specialising in AI, games, software and data will be available throughout the day to support teams as they develop their solutions.

Build → **Refine** → **Pitch**

10am
Doors open; refreshments are served, and teams continue the challenge.

12.30pm
Lunch is served

1pm
Teams demo their solutions to coaches for final scoring.

1.30pm
Coaches deliberate and nominate their highest-scoring team.

2.15pm
The shortlist is announced; the top three teams prepare their pitches while others network.

3pm
Pitches to the judging panel begin

3.30pm
Judges deliberate and award the prizes

4pm
Winners are announced, and the Ada Scotland Festival Closing Celebration begins

4.15pm
Matthew Barr gives closing remarks and begins the awards ceremony

6pm
The day ends

Future Makers Scoring Criteria

0%

100%

20% Creativity & Innovation

There's no prescribed technology or type of solution, so teams have the freedom to think differently. This category is about the originality of the idea and whether the team has found an interesting, imaginative or unexpected way to approach the problem.

- Is the concept distinctive or unexpected?
- Has the team approached the problem in a fresh way?
- Is there something memorable about the idea?
- Does it go beyond an obvious or conventional solution?

20% Accessibility & Inclusion

A solution aiming to close a gap shouldn't unintentionally create new barriers. Teams should think about the different people who might interact with their solution and make the experience as clear, approachable and inclusive as possible.

- Is the solution easy to understand and engage with?
- Has accessibility been considered?
- Has the team considered different needs and abilities?
- Does the experience avoid unnecessary barriers?

20% Problem Understanding & Impact

The heart of the challenge is understanding a genuine barrier contributing to the gender gap in STEM and identifying how technology could help. We're looking for teams that have thought carefully about the problem, who it affects and the difference their solution could make.

- Is the problem or barrier clearly defined?
- Is it clear who the solution is designed for?
- Does the solution directly address the problem identified?
- Is the potential impact clear and meaningful?

Future Makers Scoring Criteria



20% Learning & Adaptability

Future Makers is about the journey as well as the final prototype. We want teams to experiment, learn from each other, respond to what they discover and be willing to adapt their thinking as their idea develops.

- Did the team experiment or try something new?
- Did they respond to feedback or new discoveries?
- Did their thinking or solution evolve?
- Can they explain what they learnt and what they would improve next?

20% Technical Execution

The most technically complicated solution isn't necessarily the best. We're looking at how thoughtfully the team has chosen and used technology to bring their idea to life, and how effectively their prototype demonstrates what the solution could become.

- Is the chosen technology appropriate for the idea?
- Does the prototype clearly demonstrate how the solution works?
- Has technology been used purposefully rather than for the sake of it?
- How effectively has the idea been executed within the timeframe?

Pitches

- The top three teams will have the opportunity to pitch.
- Pitches should tell a compelling story about what has been achieved. Building a great application is not enough if the team cannot communicate its value to the judging panel.
- They will be chosen by the coaches, and the highest-scoring teams will progress to the pitch stage.
- During the pitches, each team will be scored against each of the judging criteria.
- Each team will have 10 minutes to pitch and will receive a warning as time runs out. They must finish when their time is up.
- The judging panel will then have an opportunity to ask up to two questions. Please keep them concise to stay on time.
- Following the pitches, the judging panel will discuss the scores and agree which teams place first, second and third.
- The judges will then announce the winners:
  - Jamie Bevers will announce runner up.
  - Lily McNally will announce runner up.
  - Lynn Love will announce winner.
- Matt Barr will give closing remarks on the overall challenge.

Judges

Jamie Bevers | Engineering Lead | Lloyds Banking Group

Lily McNally | Design Lead | Lloyds Banking Group

Matt Barr | Glasgow University, Ada Scotland Founder

Lynn Love | Abertay University

Prizes

Top 3 teams

Career Boost Package:

- CV tips
- Interview tips
- Confidence building
- Brand presence / LinkedIn

Winner

Industry insight half-day:

interview practise, CV review, idea development or next-step planning